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Culture (OWC): [Chagga \(FN04\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1906-1926

Coverage Date: 1900-1926

Place Coverage: Chagga, Tanzania

Section Title(S): 30. Embassies

Due to this arrangement it was not necessary to give any other special credentials to these envoys, and no other credentials were ever given.

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It was an innovation, suggested by a European, when Kilamia of Marangu gave a silver chain to his messenger whenever the latter went out to ask the chieftain's tribute from a European.

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Yet the situation of an extraordinary envoy was a precarious one if he had to mediate between two chieftains who constantly were at odds with each other. It was advisable for such an envoy to use his own brain, especially if he had to deal with a chieftain who was notorious for his tyrannical temper. Chieftain Sina of Kibosho was famous in this regard.

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The natives still remember a story which shows how a messenger was saved by his wit. Rindi of Moshi and Sina of Kibosho were bitter enemies.

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One day, Rindi gave the Moshi man Mnengere a message to be transmitted to Sina. The messenger knew that his life was in danger as he was aware of the fact that Sina was unpredictable. He thought to himself: the main thing is to cause Sina and his man to laugh over a joke, and he figured out how he could behave in the most ridiculous manner. He stepped before Sina and talked in broken Chagga language: "Here, councillor, cousin yours yours sends it" /I tried to imitate the broken — Chagga, which, of course, is broken — German. — Translaror/

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Sina had to laugh, and all of his men shook with laughter (menge ikavika nawanawa seko).

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The messenger acted once more in a silly way when he wanted to divulge his name to Sina. He acted in a ridiculous fashion with his warrior's pigtail and said: "Sina, Mnengere and his pigtail, how long, how long!"

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Again laughter and applause which made it clear to the envoy that he had made good capital of the vanity of these warriors who were 506 thankful for any opportunity to ridicule the opponent. The envoy was out of danger when he transmitted Rindi's message. Sina even delegated a Kibosho man to accompany Mnengere on his homeward journey so that the Moshi man would have a witness who could testify before Rindi that he had transmitted the message correctly.

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